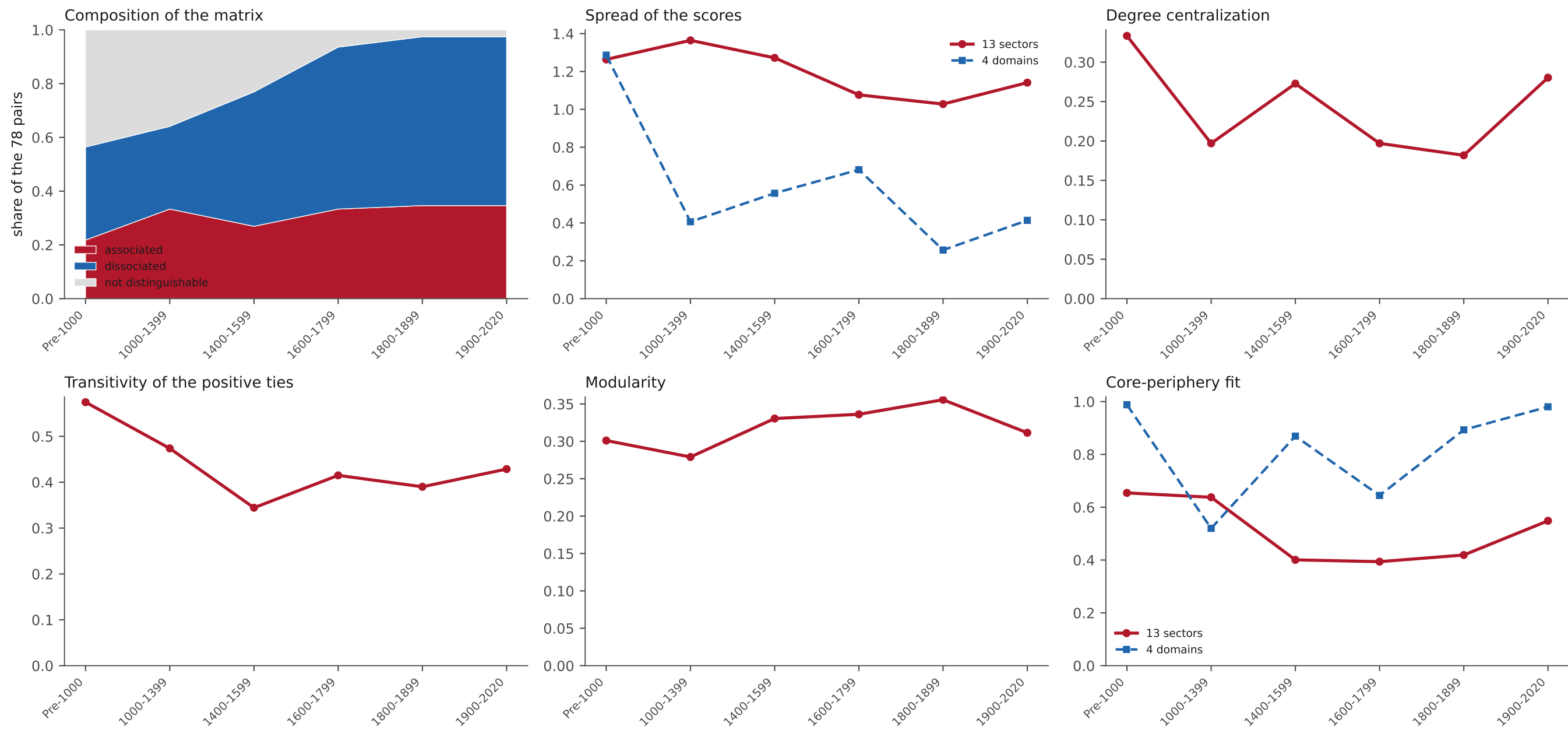


The shape of the network, not only its cells



As the record thickens the matrix resolves: the share of pairs indistinguishable from the reference model falls from 44% before 1000 to under 3% after 1800. What does not happen is concentration. Centralization ends at 0.28 against 0.33 before 1000 and modularity at 0.31 against 0.30, and across the thirteen sectors the core-periphery fit stays between 0.39 and 0.65, never high enough to say the positive ties form one core with a periphery around it. The near-perfect fit on the four domains is a statement about a network with six cells, not about concentration. Transitivity, modularity and centralization use the significant positive ties only. Source: BHHT cross-verified database of notable people (Laouenan et al., Scientific Data 9:290, 2022).